

BORROWER GUIDE

The Pre-Approval Checklist

Most loan delays don't come from your credit score — they come from missing paperwork and avoidable surprises. Walk in with this ready and you put the process on your side.

Know your numbers first

Pull your own credit and read it for errors before a lender does. Then get clear on two ratios that quietly decide your approval: debt-to-income (monthly debt ÷ gross monthly income) and loan-to-value (amount borrowed vs. property value).

Documents to gather now

- Two years of tax returns + recent W-2s or 1099s
- Most recent pay stubs (or profit-and-loss if self-employed)
- Two to three months of bank and asset statements
- A written explanation for any large or unusual deposits
- Photo ID and current address history

Don't sabotage yourself mid-process

- Don't open new credit cards or finance a car
- Don't make large unexplained deposits or withdrawals
- Don't change jobs if you can avoid it
- Stay boring and stable — underwriters re-check right before closing

The mindset

Being loan-ready isn't about being perfect — it's about being predictable and prepared. Answer questions before they're asked, explain anomalies upfront, and easy approvals close faster.